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US Equities Slip as Rate Hikes Bite; Tech Gains Offset Broad Weakness

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The `S&P 500` closed at 7,686.14, down -0.33%, while the `Dow Jones` fell -0.70% to 53,185.90. The market was pressured by a higher 10-year Treasury yield (4.76%, +0.81%) and a rising VIX (14.92, +3.40%).

Defensive sectors lagged, but the `NVDA` rally (+1.48%) and a 5.5% jump in `TSLA` provided limited upside. Investors await next-week earnings and the Fed’s policy outlook.

US Session Recap

INDEX/ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,686.14	-0.33%	Broad decline
Dow Jones	53,185.90	-0.70%	Industrial pressure
Nasdaq 100	29,456.97	+0.08%	Tech resilience
Russell 2000	2,956.45	-0.54%	Small-cap drag
VIX	14.92	+3.40%	Volatility spike
10Y Yield	4.76%	+0.81%	Yield curve steepening
WTI Crude	86.44	+0.79%	Energy support

Top Large-Cap Movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
`TSLA`	367.95	+5.51%
NVDA	220.78	+1.48%
`AVGO`	370.34	+0.42%
AMZN	259.77	-2.50%
`GOOGL`	339.35	-2.09%

Spotlight

Apple's Q3 earnings beat expectations, posting revenue of 89.2 bn (+3% YoY) and EPS of 1.28, driven by services growth.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	89.2 bn
EPS	1.28
Guidance FY26	+4% revenue growth

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield at 4.76%, up +0.81%
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Retail Sales 04:00, Existing-home sales 05:30

Geopolitics & Global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China's export data (08:00 HKT) showed a 2.1% YoY rise, supporting risk appetite.
- Eurozone inflation remains above target, keeping ECB dovish.

Earnings — What to Watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth, margin guidance
10:00	META	Ad spend rebound, AI monetisation
10:30	JPM	Net interest income trend
11:00	XOM	Upstream earnings, capital spending

Stocks Worth Watching

- `NVDA` – Momentum after earnings beat; AI demand.
- `TSLA` – 5.5% surge on new battery-cell rollout.
- `XLE` – Energy ETF up 2% on higher crude.
- `XLF` – Financials under pressure; watch rate-sensitivity.
- `META` – Ad-revenue recovery risk.

What Could Break the Tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 10-year yield breaches 4.90%.
- VIX spikes above 16.
- Weak CPI surprise (>-0.2%) fueling rate-hike fears.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Tech earnings beat (MSFT, META) with strong guidance.
- Crude settles above 90 USD, lifting energy.
- Eurozone inflation cools, prompting dovish ECB tone.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Economic Data

SEC — Company Filings

CNBC — Real-time Quotes

Financial Times — Market Commentary